03-21 第二篇

Why Do We Yawn?

You are sitting in class on a Monday morning, and suddenly your mouth opens wide in an uncontrollable yawn (打哈欠). [1] In fact, scientists have been studying this common behavior for a long time, and they have discovered some surprising things.

One popular theory is that yawning helps cool down the brain. When our brain gets too warm, it does not work as well as it should. [2] The rush of cool air that enters through a big yawn helps lower the temperature inside the skull, allowing the brain to function more efficiently.

Another fascinating discovery is that yawning is incredibly contagious (有传染性的). If you see someone yawn, there is a very high chance that you will yawn too. [3] Scientists believe this happens because yawning is linked to empathy, which is the ability to understand and share the feelings of others.

Interestingly, even animals yawn. Dogs, cats, and even fish have been observed yawning. [4] When a dog sees its owner yawn, it often yawns right back. This suggests that the bond between humans and their pets may be deeper than we ever imagined.

[5] From cooling the brain to spreading through empathy, this simple, everyday action is much more complex and interesting than most people realize.

选项

A. Some researchers even believe that dogs can "catch" yawns from people they love. B. By taking in a deep breath, yawning sends a wave of fresh, cool air to the brain. C. In short, yawning is far more than just a sign that you are bored or sleepy. D. This means that yawning is only caused by staying up too late the night before. E. You might feel a little embarrassed, but yawning is actually perfectly natural. F. In fact, simply reading about yawning right now might be making you yawn!

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] E [2] B [3] F [4] A [5] C

深度解析

- **[1] E：**

- **线索**：情境衔接与语气转折。空前描绘了一个生动的场景：周一早晨在课堂上不由自主地打哈欠。E选项"You might feel a little embarrassed, but yawning is actually perfectly natural"（你可能会觉得有点尴尬，但打哈欠其实是完全自然的）承接了课堂上打哈欠的尴尬感，并用"but"转折引入正面视角。这完美引出空后一句"In fact, scientists have been studying this common behavior for a long time"（事实上，科学家研究这个常见行为已经很久了），从日常尴尬过渡到科学探究。

- [2] B：
  - **线索**：具体机制解释与因果承接。空前提出了"打哈欠帮助大脑降温"的理论，并指出大脑过热时运作效率下降。B选项"By taking in a deep breath, yawning sends a wave of fresh, cool air to the brain"（通过深吸一口气，打哈欠向大脑输送一股新鲜的凉爽空气）精确解释了降温的物理机制。空后"The rush of cool air that enters through a big yawn helps lower the temperature"（涌入的凉爽空气帮助降低颅内温度）与B选项中的"cool air"形成词汇复现，逻辑一脉相承。

- [3] F：
  - **线索**：读者互动与现象验证。空前指出打哈欠极具传染性，看到别人打哈欠你也很可能会打。F选项"In fact, simply reading about yawning right now might be making you yawn!"（事实上，此刻仅仅是阅读关于打哈欠的文字可能就已经让你在打哈欠了！）巧妙地将传染性的概念延伸到阅读层面，让读者亲身体验这种现象。空后"Scientists believe this happens because yawning is linked to empathy"（科学家认为这是因为打哈欠与共情有关）中的"this"则回指前文描述的传染现象，包括F选项提到的阅读时打哈欠。

- [4] A：
  - **线索**：递进深化与代词衔接。空前提到甚至动物也会打哈欠——狗、猫乃至鱼都被观察到过打哈欠行为。A选项"Some researchers even believe that dogs can 'catch' yawns from people they love"（一些研究人员甚至认为狗可以从它们爱的人那里"传染"到哈欠）将话题从"动物也打哈欠"递进到"动物能从人类传染哈欠"，其中"catch"呼应了第三段的"contagious（传染性）"。空后"When a dog sees its owner yawn, it often yawns right back"（当狗看到主人打哈欠时，它往往马上打回去）就是对A选项的具体场景描绘。

- [5] C：
  - **线索**：总结归纳与全文升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首。全文从大脑降温、社会传染性、动物行为三个维度揭示了打哈欠的奥秘。C选项"In short, yawning is far more than just a sign that you are bored or sleepy"（简而言之，打哈欠远不止是无聊或困倦的信号）用"In short"精准总结，推翻了人们对打哈欠的刻板印象。空后"From cooling the brain to spreading through empathy"回顾了文章要点，与C选项的总结形成呼应。

- **干扰项分析**：
    - **D. This means that yawning is only caused by staying up too late the night before.**：该选项含有因果指代词"This means"和"yawning"等话题词汇，看似可以放在解释打哈欠原因的段落。但其"only caused by staying up too late"（仅仅是因为熬夜）的绝对化表述与全文揭示的多元原因（大脑降温、共情传染等）完全矛盾。"only"一词是典型的以偏概全型干扰项标志。